

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

# THAT WIRE FRAUD EMAIL IS **NOT** THE FIX.

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AI can now fake the phone call that's supposed to catch it.

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**THE FBI SAYS REAL  
ESTATE FRAUD  
STOLE MORE THAN  
\$275 MILLION IN  
2025.**

From at least 12,368 victims. One wire, one wrong  
number.



## THE MISTAKE IS TRUSTING THE VERIFICATION, NOT SKIPPING IT.

Most agents already tell clients "call before you wire." The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center ties last year's fraud surge to AI-generated impersonation: convincing fake emails, cloned voices, and personalized messages that make the follow-up call part of the con instead of the safeguard. In one case NAR reported, a buyer at closing wired more than \$449,000 after a scammer posed as the closing attorney by email, and the buyer believed they had already confirmed it.



# THE SWAP, BEFORE YOUR NEXT CLOSING:

- 1 Never call a number from the email.**  
Use the number already saved from your first real conversation with the title company or attorney, not the one printed at the bottom of "updated wiring instructions."
- 2 Treat any last-minute change to wiring instructions as fraud until proven otherwise.**  
A real title company does not change account numbers three days before closing over email.
- 3 Say this to every client before they wire a cent.**  
"Nobody, including me, will ever email you new wiring instructions. If you get one, call me first, on the number you already have."



## THE TAKEAWAY

# THE WARNING EMAIL WAS NEVER THE SAFEGUARD.

The independently-verified phone call is. Make sure your client knows the difference.